Junior Hub
Child Care & Learning Centre

FAMILY HANDBOOK

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Welcome to Junior Hub Child Care & Learning Centre (JHCCLC)

On behalf of the staff and Board of Directors thank you for choosing Junior Hub Child Care & Learning Centre.

We believe that a child's early years set the foundation for life-long learning in all developmental areas. We also believe that every child is unique with his/her own learning style and pace. JHCCLC is committed to providing highly qualified, play-based programs that meet the ever growing and changing needs of a child's development. At JHCCLC, All families and children are welcome! We provide equal opportunities to maximise the full potential of every child.

JHCCLC operates in compliance with the Ministry of Education, following the guidelines of the Child Care and Early Years Act (CCEYA) (2014) and the York Region Public Health Unit. This Parent Handbook has been compiled to provide you with JHCCLC policies and procedures that govern our program. We are so honoured that you have chosen to place your child in the care of our dedicated Registered Early Childhood Educators (RECE)and experienced Early Childhood Assistant (ECA). We look forward to having an affirming and respectful relationship with families. It is imperative that all parents fully understand the Centre's policies and procedures as they are the agreed upon terms of admission.

Our Curriculum and Program

Mission and Philosophy

Junior Hub Child Care & Learning Centre is formed to provide a safe, friendly, stimulating environment to promote children's physical, social, emotional and cognitive development.

We believe that every child is unique and possesses his/her own temperament and learning style. We believe play is integral to children's learning and essential to quality of life in childhood. Exploration and play are a child's primary way of understanding the world. Children are agents of their own learning, actively building knowledge, skills, dispositions, and feelings. We are committed to fostering each child's self-esteem, well-being and growing need for independence. All aspects of their development and learning are interrelated and interdependent.

Program Statement

At JHCCLC, our young learners are supported in the development of positive and effective communication. Early on, children experience meaningful opportunities and individual support related to expression and self-regulation. Rich in potential and ability, children develop understanding and competence in emotional expression, emotional intelligence and self-awareness. Expression is supported through observation, documentation, listening, and reciprocal communication. Child-initiated communication creates a pathway to self-regulation and problem solving.

We believe that children are competent, capable of complex thinking, curious and rich in potential. We are committed to the **"emergent curriculum"** approach to program planning, in which activities "emerge" based on ideas and interests from both children and staff. This spontaneous learning process prepares them for acquiring more complex skills of reading, writing and mathematical reasoning.

Curriculum and Program Schedules

Our program uses observation and documentation to plan play-based learning experiences that encourage active exploration, inquiry, independence, choices, problem solving, wonder and theory building. Purposeful planned activities, inquiries and provocation will stem from interests of the children. Regular communications between families and educators are emphasised in our program. We believe that parents play an irreplaceable role in their children's development. It is important for our educators to share their knowledge, experience, resources and learnings with families via various media like phone calls, emails, documentations, etc.



We recognize the importance of loose parts and integrate them into our programs. Loose parts are materials that can be moved, carried, combined, redesigned, lined up, and taken apart and put back together in multiple ways. They are materials with no specific set of directions and can be used alone or combined with other materials. Loose parts allow children opportunities to discover and master their environment.

Using the common framework in *How Does Learning Happen?* Ontario's Pedagogy for the Early Years (2014), our Centre supports the children to achieve their goals in the following four developmental areas:

Belonging	Every child has a sense of belonging when he/she is connected to others and contributes to his/her world.
Well-Being	Every child is developing a sense of self and health and well-being.
Engagement	Every child is an active and engaged learner who explores the world with body, mind and senses.
Expression	Every child is a capable communicator who is able to express himself/herself in many ways.

	Toddler 18 months to 2.5 years 1 staff:5 children	**Preschool** 2.5year-4 years 1 staff : 8 children	**Kindergarten(JK-Sk)** 5 years-6 years 1 staff : 13 children
Full-time 7:30 am-6:00 pm	Our toddler program provides children opportunities for safe, supervised play, while encouraging their exploration and desire to test the boundaries of their abilities. Educators offer children a variety of creative, sensory, language, music and motor experiences. As social skills develop,	Educators offer a variety of activities and experiences based on the emerging skills and interests of children. Art, games, loose parts play, sensory play and cooking all foster emerging language, literacy, numeracy and science skills such as observing, inferring and predicting. Dramatic play, music,	Montessori Curriculum (September - June) Summer Camp (July and August) March Break Winter Break PA day French, Chinese, Music enriched program

Part-time 9:00 am - 12:00 pm 1:30 pm - 4:30pm	educators support toddlers with their emerging capacity for interactive and cooperative play in a warm, positive environment.s	movement and gross motor experiences also build language and social skills, and physical competency. Through careful planning of environments, children learn to explore, differentiate, make choices, and understand more complex concepts. Viewing children as competent and capable, we encourage the development of independence, resilience and self-help skills.	

Waitlist

It is never too early to add your child to our waitlist.

A waitlist is maintained at Junior Hub Child Care & Learning Centre, for families who either require immediate care but there are currently no applicable spaces available, or for future care needs.

The child's name is placed in the appropriate age group (based on licensed aged group) waitlist according to the date the request is made and when care is required.

The waitlist will be managed in the following way:

- Families at the top of the waitlist, in the age appropriate group, will be contacted using the phone number and/or email they provide when a space becomes available.
- Families will have three (3) business days to reply indicating if they wish to place their child at JHCCLC or if they choose to decline a space.
- In the event that the family declines the space their name is either removed from the list or the date for needing care is changed.
- The next family on the list will be contacted.

Priority is given to a child on the waitlist if they have a sibling currently enrolled in the Centre and employees of JHCCLC. Parents will be reminded to add the name of siblings in a timely manner.

Families that request updates regarding their current place on the waitlist will be notified of how many families in the same age group, for the same time frame, are ahead of them. If a family wishes to see the waitlist to confirm their child's position, the supervisor or the designated staff will only show the family when they have blocked out the names and contact information of other families in order to maintain privacy.

NO FEE or DEPOSIT will be charged for being placed on the waitlist.
*Placement on the waitlist is not a guarantee of space in the Centres, a space cannot be confirmed unless the site supervisor has provided confirmation of space and a deposit has been received to secure the space

Educator Credential and Screening

At Junior Hub, the supervisor and all our Early Childhood Educators are professionals registered with the College of Early Childhood Educators. All employees are trained in Standard First Aid, AED and CPR-C, Accessibility for Ontarians with Disabilities (AODA), and Health & Safety Awareness. Designated educators are trained in Workplace Hazardous Materials Information System (WHMIS) and hold Food Handling Certification.

The supervisor, all educators, volunteers and students require a Police Vulnerable Sector Check (PVSC) prior to interacting with children and every five (5) years thereafter. In addition, Annual Offense Declarations are signed during the period specified in the declaration. Individuals (with other agencies) who attend our programs e.g. early interventionists, therapists, will provide vulnerable sector screening verification prior to interacting with the children. All educators, volunteers and students must provide proof of medical requirements according to the local health authority, i.e. two step TB tests, DPT and MMR.

At Junior Hub Child Care & Learning Centre, we believe that children deserve to be surrounded by knowledgeable and qualified educators. All the educators are provided with the opportunities to further their learning, understanding and expanding on their career aspirations. We promote and support each educator's continuous professional learning (CPL) by attending workshops, seminars or courses.

Enrollment and Fee Schedules

Admissions and Registration

As per the Supervisor has confirmed a space for your child, the enrolment forms need to be completed, in their entirety, and returned to the Supervisor prior to your child's first day. Other forms that must accompany the enrolment forms where applicable include: an up to date copy of your child's immunizations record, which is forwarded to the York Region Public Health Unit. Under *the Child Care and Early Years Act, 2014*, for parents who choose not to immunize exemptions are to be documented as follows on a Ministry approved form:

• For medical exemptions, a legally qualified medical practitioner must complete the "Statement of Medical Exemption Form".

• For religious or philosophical exemptions, a “Statement of Conscience or Religious Belief’s Form” must be completed by a “Commissioner for taking avadavat” (i.e. It must be notarised)

Settling in Period

A successful settling in period for a child can ease the child and parents’ anxiety into a new child care environment that involves many routines and transitions throughout the day. Another important factor is that your child will need to adjust to many new friends and adults in his/her life.

Visiting the Centre prior to your child's first day is recommended for all the families. Book an appointment with the supervisor and enjoy the additional opportunity to familiarise with our environment, facilities and educators. It is also a good chance for our educators to know about your child's family routines, specific needs and your concerns.

Every child’s adjusting time varies. It is important to encourage your child to follow our daily routine and interact with other children but we do not force or rush. It takes time, patience and consistency for a child to get used to the program. For some children, we may recommend starting from shorter days and gradually extending their care time. Our experienced staff and the supervisor will work closely with the parents to make the transition as comfortable as possible.

Fee Schedules

HCCLC provides both full time and part time care. Program fees vary depending on the program your child is enrolled in. Please refer to the Appendix A

Payment

Once a space has been accepted by a family, a one-time family registration fee of $150.00 is required to enrol your child(ren) in the program.

Our monthly fees are pre-rated and can be paid by Electronic Funds Transfer (EFT) or cash. Families with a single child are required to make payment in full by the 1st of the month. Families with two or more children are able to make payment in two equal instalments paid on the 1st and 15th of the month. A security deposit of $200 per family is required. It will apply to any outstanding balance, late pick-up fee or NSF.

All payments returned from the bank (i.e. NSF) will be subject to a processing fee of $40.

A fee schedule is attached to this handbook as an appendix. Fees are subject to change at any time with a minimum of one month’s notice to families. There is no reduction in fees for vacation, holiday closures or illness.

Tax Receipt

Tax receipts will be available for pick up after February 1st of each year for the previous taxation year. Receipts can be obtained from the supervisor. If you relocate, please provide a forwarding address to the Supervisor. Any questions or concerns regarding your receipt should be directed to the Supervisor.

Holidays and Closures

Hours of Operation are open Monday through Friday from 7:30 a.m. to 6:00 p.m. year-round, excluding the following Statutory Holidays listed below:

- New Year's Day
- Good Friday & Easter Monday
- Canada Day
- Labour Day
- Christmas Day
- Family Day
- Victoria Day
- Civic Holiday
- Thanksgiving
- Boxing Day

** Note: JHCCLC also closes at 3:00 p.m. on Christmas Eve and New Year's Eve. In the event that these holidays fall on a weekend, families will be informed of the closure. Please note all families are responsible for full fees on the above Statutory Holidays.

Our goal is to provide service under all circumstances. However, unexpected closures due to conditions beyond our control may result in an inability to provide services within our regular hours of operation. It may also be necessary to provide care at an alternate location. JHCCLC makes every effort to provide the regular level of care in these situations. In the case of a prolonged closure, the Board of Directors will determine any changes to hours of operation. Families will be advised of changes through the email or call as soon as possible.

Withdrawal Policy

Parents are required to submit a minimum of thirty (30) days written notice for termination of care. Those providing less notice will be required to pay for care based on the daily rate for the full thirty 30 days' term of notice.

Dismissal Policy

All parents/guardians are expected to be familiar with and adhere to the Centre's policies and procedures at all times. If a family fails to comply with JHCCLC's policies and procedures the following will apply:

1) Written warning by the Supervisor
2) Written warning by the Board of Directors
3) Failure to comply after written warnings will result in the dismissal of your child

The time frame for notice will be based on the nature of the circumstance. Each situation will be addressed through a process with the best interest of all children, families and the Centre in mind. Reasons for dismissal from Junior Hub Child Care & Learning Centre:

- Failure to comply with family policies and practices outlined in this handbook
- Failure to treat staff, children and/or families with respect
- A child's behaviour is a threat to the safety of self, other children, educators, or property
- A parent is abusive (physical, verbal or emotional)
- Consistently Nonpayment of fees
- Consistently disregard of operation hours

Family Partnership Policies and Procedures

Family Involvement

JHCCLC believes that families are their child's first and best teacher. We recognize that parent partnership is a key ingredient to the quality and success of our Centre. We are committed to respecting the values, differences, needs and interests of individual families. We encourage and welcome parents' knowledge, experience, ideas and feedback. An integral strength of JHCCLC is our willingness and ability to meet the needs of the children, parents and educators in a mutually beneficial partnership. It is important that educators and families communicate frequently about family practices at home to avoid confusion for the children. Verbal or written systems are appreciated in regard to the happenings that may be affecting your child, changes in a child's physical or emotional state should be reported regularly to teachers.



JHCCLC educators seek out ways to engage parents in a way that meets their needs and builds on strengths while respecting the challenges that face families. Special events and organized parent involvement opportunities will be offered throughout the year.

The JHCCLC Family Handbook is provided to both prospective families and those enrolled. The Family Handbook will be circulated to families following any instrumental change and they will be required to confirm receipt of the updated version(s).

If at any time you have questions or concerns, please feel free to speak with the educators or the supervisor. You may also submit your feedback in the comments and suggestions box located at the sign-in desk in the reception area. We thank you for your feedback, which will provide valued information about how we can improve our child care programs or services.

Arrivals and Departures

Upon arrival at JHCCLC, children must be escorted by a parent or guardian into their classroom to an educator. Parents notify the educators directly, so they are aware your child has arrived and help him/her make the transition from home to daycare. Educators must know exactly who is in their care at all times so your child should never be dropped off at the front door. Parents or guardians are asked to share any information regarding their child's health, alternative pick up arrangements etc. Educators in turn will share any information they need to pass on to the family. Educators will mark the attendance sheet to indicate that the child is now in their care and the time that the child arrived.

At the end of the day parents or guardians must connect directly with an educator prior to departing with their child. Educators will mark the attendance sheet to indicate that the child is no longer in their care.It is essential for the protection of the children that they will be released only to those on the authorized list completed on the child's registration papers, unless a written note is received specifying otherwise.Valid photo identification is required of individuals other than the parents/guardians. Please ensure the person designated to pick up your child has an appropriate car seat for your child. Parents/guardians must keep us informed of any changes in the enrolment information provided. Please inform us if any contact information or addresses for all those listed on the emergency contacts as well as any authorized or unauthorized persons should change to ensure we may update your records.

Absenteeism

If your child will not be attending daycare for any reason please inform the Centre as soon as possible to ensure we may continue on our regular schedule without postponing activities, outings, meals, as well as to ensure proper staffing. Also, please notify the staff if your child will not be attending due to health reasons, as the illness may require the York Region Public Health Unit to be notified, an information form to be posted as well as increased cleaning procedures. No refund or credit will be given for scheduled days not attended.

Authorized/ Emergency Pick-up Persons

Upon enrollment parents or guardians provide a list of persons authorized to pick up their child(ren). Should an authorized pick up person arrive for the child, the child will not be released until the educator has verified the individual with their government issued photo ID (e.g. driver's license, health card).

Alternate Pick-up Persons

Parents may contact JHCCLC through email and phone to request a previously unauthorized person be authorized to pick up their child(ren). Upon arriving to pick up the child, identification will be requested. The child will not be released without a government issued photo ID (e.g. driver's license, health card). The child will not be released to anyone not listed as an authorized pick up or without previous direction from the parents or guardians.

Multi- Household Families and Custody Policy

In the event that the family's situation requires additional attention regarding access to the child(ren) due to custodial arrangements, parents/guardians are required to share this information with the Supervisor upon admission. The special circumstances will be discussed with the educators who will follow the directions as provided.

Late pick-up Procedure

If you are going to be later than our closing time due to unforeseen circumstances, please notify the Centre as soon as possible.You must make alternate arrangements for your child to be picked up. Educators MUST be notified if a person other than yourself is coming for your child. A late fee of $2.00 per minute is charged to parents/guardians who fail to pick their child(ren) by our closing time (6:00 p.m.). Time will be calculated using the designated clock at the Centre. Parents/guardians must initial the attendance as they are leaving the Centre. Parents will be invoiced for the fees incurred and paid by cash immediately or no late on the following attendance day. This fee is not tax deductible and will not be included in your year-end tax receipt

The following is an outline of what would happen if the educators have not heard from parents by 6:00 p.m.:

- The educators will try to contact you using all contact numbers listed/available to us.
- The supervisor will be notified.
- The educators will then try to contact the authorized persons on the registration forms.

"Excessive Lateness" – When a child has not been picked up from the child care centre a half hour or more past closing time, with no phone call being made to advise staff of the circumstances involved and none of the identified "Persons Approved for Pick-up" reachable or available to come and get the child, there will be no other option left for JHCCLC but to contact the Children's Aid Society and City of York Region Police. A notice will be placed at the

entrance of the childcare Centre, with written instruction on how to contact the Children's Aid Society for further direction.If the educators are unable to reach the authorized persons or those persons are unable to pick up your child, then the supervisor or designate will be contacted and has the authority to contact the Children's Aid Society and/or York Regional Police.

Authorized pickups/emergency contacts are a registration requirement. Recommended people for authorized pick up are a relative, family friend or neighbor.

Cases of extreme weather conditions or unusual emergencies will be dealt with by the supervisor on an individual basis.

Health and Wellness

Health Policy

Parents/guardians notify the Centre as soon as possible if your child will not be attending due to illness or has been exposed to any contagious or communicable disease. In order to ensure the overall health and safety of all the children and staff, you will be contacted if your child becomes ill as well you are asked to keep your child from the Centre if he/she displays the following:

- An elevated temperature of 38.0°C (100.4°F)
- Vomiting • Diarrhea
- Eyes or ears discharge
- Visible rashes
- Any communicable disease including: Impetigo, Coxsackie Virus, Fifth Disease, German Measles, Hepatitis A or B, Meningitis, Measles, Mumps, Whooping Cough, Scabies, Scarlet Fever, Strep Throat, or Tuberculosis
- Bronchitis or pneumonia.

It is important that your child is well enough to participate in all the activities of the Centre. In compliance with Ministry regulations, we are unable to provide care for sick children at the Centre.

Educators must greet each child and complete a visual wellness check as they arrive at the program, to ensure that they are well enough to participate. Parents/guardians who arrive at a Centre with a child, who is visibly unwell, will be politely advised that they are not able to stay.

Any health observations are referenced on the attendance record and noted in the classroom logbook. Any child who has visible signs/symptoms of illness such as, but not limited to, fever, vomiting or diarrhea *cannot* attend the program. If a child is observed to be ill, parents will be

contacted and expected to pick-up immediately. The health and welfare of the children is our primary concern.

Health Outbreak in the Centre When the Health Unit declares the centre is in outbreak the staff are

- to remove all sensory activities from the room to wash toys within the room daily
- Hand washing and sanitary practices are to be increased
- All bedding and soft materials are to be laundered on the day that the outbreak is declared in addition to the weekly laundry schedule.

York Region Public Health outlines illness/disease which require exclusion from the Centre. The posting of this information is in the hall near the kitchen. We will follow all recommendations required by Public Health.

Inclusion



Our Mission Statement indicates that we provide a high quality early learning program where ALL children learn through play and inquiry. At JHCCLC we believe that every:

- Child is an individual – unique and special
- Child has the right to be treated equitably and with dignity and respect
- Child benefits from quality early learning
- Child needs opportunities to grow, develop and learn to their fullest potential
- Child needs to engage in friendship building and social inclusion
- Family has a right to engage in employment, training, and support while knowing their child is being cared at a quality child care Centre

Head Lice Policy

In the event that a child is suspected of having head lice (e.g. itchy scalp), a discreet head check will be conducted by an educator in a safe and supportive climate for the child. If a child has lice, the parent or guardian will be contacted and asked to pick up their child from the Centre. The parent or guardian would be required to treat the child's hair/head with medicated lice shampoo and remove all lice and/or nits with a nit comb. When the child returns to the Centre after treatment, it is the responsibility of the parent to continue to check their child's hair to ensure all lice are removed.

After treating your child for head lice and upon returning to the Centre a head check will be completed on your child before leaving your child at the Centre. Should we find any nits or signs of lice you will be asked to take your child and remove all nits before returning to the centre. This will be completed within the Supervisor's office when possible. The second treatment for head lice must be applied to your child and we will be requesting confirmation of application after seven days. Please complete the additional at home treatments to prevent

another outbreak. This may seem a bit extreme to some families however it is the best way to prevent further spreading and to aggressively eliminate the head lice outbreak.

Daily Outdoor Play

How Does Learning Happen? Ontario's Pedagogy for the Early Years, (2014) states that children thrive



in outdoor spaces that invite them to investigate, imagine, think, create, solve problems, and make meaning from their experiences. JHCCLC agrees that outdoor play is an important element of the children's day and time outdoors should Centre on inquiry, exploration and making sense of their environment to enhance children's development. The program should promote creative and constructive play that involves the same level of positive educator/ child interaction that occurs inside. All children in our Centre will experience daily outdoor time, weather permitting. A minimum of two hours daily is required for licensing however we strive to spend as much time as possible outdoors, weather permitting.

Asthma/Anaphylaxis/ Allergies/ Medical Health Policy

Children who are attending and educators working at JHCCLC are entitled to a safe and healthy learning environment. This aligns with Sabrina's Law, 2005 and the amendments to the Child Care and Early Years Act, 2014 (CCEYA), which outlines communication strategies and explains Individual Child Plans (ICP). Parents will be informed of food allergies and food restrictions so that they are made aware of foods that will not be served in the Centre. Updated information regarding food allergies and food restrictions will be communicated to parents in a timely manner in writing and through emails.

Within this policy, parents are responsible:

- To inform the Centre if their child has a life-threatening allergy and/ or medical needs and ensure relevant individualized plans are duly completed.
- Provide training to staff, students and volunteers as required or training video of how to administer life-saving medication or medical procedure and updated regularly to ensure the most accurate information is on hand to the educators.
- To ensure they have completed the relevant forms entitled the *Anaphylactic Reaction Protocol; Individualized Plan for a Child with Medical Needs; and Medication/ Treatment Record for Emergencies or Special Circumstance*.
- For providing the Centre with the appropriate medication i.e. Epi-Pen, puffer.

Children, with an anaphylactic allergy or other medical need, will not be admitted into our Centre until all necessary forms are completed, training has been provided and we have the appropriate medication.

Parents are asked to share all allergies, sensitivities and medical needs for their child, upon enrolment. This information will be posted to ensure all educators are aware of your child's needs. All food allergies, sensitivities, restrictions and medical needs will be posted in food preparation and food service areas, visible to all educators.

For children with anaphylactic allergy, special dietary, the Supervisor will work on an alternative menu with the parent. The Supervisor will inform the catering representative to confirm the alternative menu. Children with special nutritional or feeding arrangements must be fed following the parent's written instructions.

For food from home, the parent has to agree to follow:

1. Nut-free and allergen-free ingredients. We encourage parents to set up a weekly menu with ingredients listed for the child.
2. Labeled child's name
3. Keep food in the container for microwave friendly use if you need to warm-up. The food must be kept in the refrigerator in the kitchen. Cook will provide food at the food serving time.
4. Staff members monitor during the food serving time to ensure no sharing of food in the classroom.
5. The leftover food and container will be returned to the kitchen. Parents will bring it home every day.

JHCCLC works with families to assess the accommodation on a case to case approval basis.

Immunization Policy

JHCCLC adheres to the requirements of the Ontario Immunization Schedule and the Child Care & Early Years Act (2014) to ensure children are fully immunized prior to admission.



Your child's immunization record is collected as part of the enrollment package and children will only be allowed to attend when all information is on file. Immunization records will be shared with York Region Public Health (YRPH). Children's records are reviewed annually to ensure information is current. YRPH will contact parents/guardians if their child has an incomplete immunization record.

If families wish to not immunize their child, we require a written exemption with a stated medical, conscientious or religious reason, which will be kept in the child's file. If an outbreak of a vaccine preventable disease occurs, children not immunized will be excluded from attending the program to reduce their risk of being infected.

Medication Policy

The medication policy for JHCCLC adheres to the regulations outlined in the Child Care and Early Years Act (2014).

Prescription Medication

- All prescription medication must be in their original container. A pharmacist's label must be attached to the container, showing the doctor's name, date, child's name, dosage and times to be given.
- Parents will be required to complete and sign a Medication Form which will provide permission for the educators to administer any prescription medication.
- Only current medication will be given.
- If your child requires an Epi-Pen it is the parent's responsibility to ensure that the Epi-Pen is available and current through completion of medical forms and training video.

Non-Prescription Medications

- Non-prescription medication i.e. Tylenol, Benadryl, or cough medications must be labeled with your child's full name and current date.
- Parents will be required to complete and sign a Medication Form prior to educators being able to administer any non-prescription medication. Please note: the dosage the parent requests must not exceed the dosage recommended on the label.
- Only current medication will be given.

Medication must be given directly to the educators and **NOT** left in the child's knapsack or cubby. The child's prescription and non-prescription drug or medication must be accompanied by a Scheduled Medication/Treatment Record or Medication/ Treatment Record for Emergencies or Special Circumstances, which serves as written authorization. This is to be completed by the parent/guardian. The Medication Form must be filled out before you leave the Centre. In the event that an incorrect medication is administered parents/guardians will be notified immediately.

Nutrition

Nutrition education and the promotion of healthy attitudes towards food are an important part of the care we provide for the children. A hot nutritious noon meal and two snacks (early morning and mid-afternoon) are provided daily for all children. As required by Health Canada and 2% M.F. milk as needed to toddler and preschool children at morning snack and lunch. Water will be served with the afternoon snack. Parents provide a water bottle, labeled with your child's name, allowing ongoing access to water. Fresh fruit will also be available to the children at all times.



JHCCLC provide the Yummy Catering meals follow the guidelines of the Canada Food Guide. Weekly menus are posted on the Family Information Board and any alternatives are noted. Peanuts and peanut products are not used in any food preparation at this Centre.

At least one staff member of JHCCLC will have successfully completed the examination based on York Region Public Health Ontario Ministry of Food Handler Training Protocol.

The supervisor must be alerted to any food allergies, sensitives or restrictions upon enrolment. Substitutions, to the best of our ability, will be made to accommodate your child's needs. In the event your child has a life-threatening allergy then the policy addressing anaphylactic protocol must be followed.

Diaper/Toilet Training

Parents are required to provide diapers and wipes for their children. We follow all public health guidelines for diaper changing routines. The diaper change area is disinfected after every diaper change and the educators will wash their hands after every change. If your child requires diaper cream of any kind you will need to complete a permission form allowing educators to apply the cream. When using our change table, please follow the instructions posted on the wall. This will help keep a safe and sanitary environment for all the children in our care. We welcome cloth diapers at our facility. If you wish to use cloth, please speak to the Supervisor upon enrollment for specific information.

We believe that each child develops at his or her own pace. In accordance with this, we will never force a child to sit on the toilet. However, at each diaper change, we will ask your child if they would like to try sitting on the toilet. We also bring a few children into the bathroom at the same time to encourage learning from each other. Please let us know what method you follow so that we may provide as much consistency for your child as possible. If your child is toilet training, we ask that you supply a complete extra set of clothing in order to accommodate needed changes should they be required.

Rest and Sleep Period

All children will have the opportunity for a rest period up to two hours following lunchtime. Children who are unable to sleep are not kept on their bed longer than one hour and will be allowed to engage in a quiet activity. Parents/guardians may request children have a sleep limit or provide a written request that their child enrolled in our senior



preschool program not to nap. Each child will be provided with a cot or crib and sheet, based on their program. Their beds will be labeled and all bedding is laundered at a minimum of once a week on premises. Lights are dimmed and soft music will be played. All classrooms will be supervised through sleep time and children will be assisted to sleep when necessary, i.e. rubbing of back.
Educators will be positioned so that they are able to visually monitor the sleeping children.

The requirements under CCEYA are (a) each child in a licensed toddler or preschool group who receives child care for six hours or more in a day has a rest period not exceeding two hours in length; and (b) each child in a licensed toddler, preschool or kindergarten group is permitted to sleep, rest or engage in quiet activities based on the child's needs.

Safety and Emergencies

Activities off the Premises

On occasion, we will notify parents when the preschoolers and Kindergarteners will be taken for walks in the community. Children will be supervised at all times when off premise and educators will have cell phones with them for added safety. These community outings enrich the children's experiences and allow for the children to learn about their neighborhood.

Recommendation for Clothing

Please ensure your child comes to the Centre each day dressed in comfortable, washable clothing suitable for messy play. Please keep a complete change of clothing for your child in their cubby. All personal items need to be clearly labelled with your child's full name. Since outdoor play is an important part of our program, your child should be dressed according to the weather.
Children should have two (2) pairs of footwear, one for indoor use and one for outdoor use. The intent is to maintain a safe and clean indoor environment (this also applies to educators).
Please provide indoor shoes which can be left at the Centre.

Sun safety



Children go outside each day weather permitting. We often bring our indoor program outside and stay out for extended periods of time. In order to protect the child, we recommend a sun hat each day. Parents/guardians provide a bottle of sunscreen, not spray, labeled with your child's name which can be kept at the Centre.

Educators will apply sunscreen prior to going outside based on written permission form provided by parents/guardians .

Safe Drink Water

According to O. Reg. 243/07, flushing and sampling of drinking water is a requirement in Child Care Centres, schools and private schools. JHCCLC will ensure the provision of safe drinking water by complying with all flushing and testing regulations as set out by the Ministry of the Environment.

No Smoking



In compliance with the Smoke-Free Ontario Act, 2017 Junior Hub Child Care & Learning Centre prohibits the smoking of tobacco and medical cannabis and the use of electronic cigarettes, by all employees, parents and visitors to the Centre. This applies to both inside and on outdoor groups of the Centre whether or not children are present. Signage indicating that smoking is prohibited (i.e. “No Smoking” signs) are posted at all entrances and exits

Serious Accidents/ Illness

Emergency Medical Attention Procedures In an emergency, staff will take any or all of the following actions:

- Call an ambulance (911)
- Contact a parent or guardian
- Contact the emergency contacts
- Administer reasonable first aid measures

***A condition of enrolment is the understanding that you are consenting for your child to be transported to the hospital, in case of an emergency, and consent to emergency treatment until the time of your arrival at the hospital*.**

All accidents, injuries or illnesses will be reported to parents and documented on an Accident, Incident or Illness report for the parents to read and sign that they have been notified about the follow-up procedures taken. Educators will follow the Serious Occurrence Reporting Procedures outlined in #1.6 as required.

Emergency Procedures

Emergency drills are conducted once a month. During drills, the children are taken outside the Centre to the designated area by the playground fence via exit #3 (rear exit).

In the event of a major emergency that requires evacuation of the building, the designated evacuation site isEmergency Shelter:

Location: Thornhill Baptist Church

Address: 8018 Yonge Street, Thornhill, Ontario L4J 1W3

Telephone: (905) 889 – 3294

Every effort will be made to notify all parents that an evacuation has occurred by telephone or e-mail whenever possible. Parents will be required to pick their children up at the evacuation site as soon as possible.

A notice of communication in regard to the emergency will be sent to all parents by email within 24 hours of the emergency and the Serious Occurrence Summary Report will be posted for 10 business days on the notice board for parents to review, in compliance with Serious Occurrence Reporting Procedures. If parents have any questions, they may contact the supervisor. The supervisor will provide information in regard to the emergency as soon as it becomes available, provide updates to the Child Care Licensing System and post any updated Serious Occurrence Summary Reports.

Should further follow up be identified in regard to distress experienced by the children and/ or parents as a result of the emergency, the Ministry of Education Consultant, Board of Directors and other appropriate professionals i.e. Emergency Management Ontario, Children's Aid Society, Police Department, York Region Public Health will be contacted and support provided according to recommendations and procedures outlined in the Emergency Management Policy and Procedures # 1.34.

A notice concerning operations and resumption of operations will be completed the same business day to notify parents whether the Centre will be opened for business the next day or whether other arrangements for care will need to be made. Parents will be notified by phone and/ or e-mails when the Centre will resume operations or if there will be an extended closure.

Prohibited Practices, Monitoring and Contraventions

All Junior Hub CCLC educators must adhere to the Prohibited Practices Policy which addresses the prohibited practices identified in the CCEYA that are not permitted under any circumstances:

a) Corporal punishment of a child (including but not limited to hitting, spanking, slapping, pinching);
b) Physical restraint of a child, such as confining a child in a seat or device for the purposes of discipline or in lieu of supervision unless the physical restraint is for the purpose of preventing a child from hurting themselves or somebody else and is used only as a last resort and only until the risk of injury is no longer imminent;
c) Locking the exits of the program for the purposes of confining the child, or confining the child in an area or room without adult supervision, unless such confinement occurs during an emergency and is required as part of emergency management protocol;

d) Use of harsh or degrading measures or threats or use of derogatory language directed at or used in the presence of a child that would humiliate, shame or frighten a child or undermine his or her self-respect, dignity or self-worth;
e) Depriving a child of basic needs including food, drink, shelter, sleep, toilet use, clothing, and bedding;
f) Inflicting any bodily harm on children including making children eat or drink against their will.

In addition, Contraventions of Prohibited Practices also applies to anaphylaxis protocols, individualized support plans and individualized plans for children with medical needs. Staff are monitored for contraventions of prohibited practices, according to the Contraventions of Prohibited Practices Policy # 1.33 and contraventions will lead to disciplinary measures depending on the seriousness of the contravention.

Serious Occurrences

All Serious Occurrences are reported to the Ministry of Education as defined by the Child Care and Early Years Act. Serious occurrence reporting is one of many tools providing JHCCLC and the Ministry of Education with an effective means of monitoring the quality of care that our programs are providing.

- When a Serious Occurrence has occurred
- the Executive Director is notified immediately the serious occurrences is submitted within 24 hours the board of directors are notified of the occurrence
- A notification form is posted for parents to view for 10 days with details regarding the incident.This posting will give parents information about the incident and outline follow-up actions taken and the outcomes, while respecting the privacy of the individual involved. When applicable, longer-term actions taken by the operator will also be included to help prevent similar incidents in the future.

A serious occurrence is defined as:

- A life-threatening injury or illness to a child,
- A missing or unsupervised child
- Abuse, neglect or death of a child
- An unplanned disruption of operations i.e. a fire or other disaster on premise

Suspected Abuse or Neglect of a Child

Everyone, including members of the public and professionals who work closely with children is required by law to report suspected cases of child abuse or neglect.

If a parent/guardian expresses concerns that a child is being abused or neglected, the parent will be advised to contact the local child protection agency, Children's Aid Society (CAS) or Catholic Children's Aid Society directly.

Any persons who become aware of such concerns are also responsible for reporting this information to CAS as per the "Duty to Report" requirement under the *Child and Family Services Act*.

Positive Guidance

Positive guidance strategies are used to meet the needs and align with the developmental level of individual children. Research shows that children who attend Centres where they experience warm, supportive relationships are happier, less anxious, and more motivated to learn than those who do not. Experiencing positive relationships in early childhood have significant long-term impacts on physical and mental health, and success in school and beyond.

At JHCCLC we believe young children benefit from an affirming approach that encourages positive interactions with other children and with adults. In order to support children in their acquisition of social and emotional competencies, educators will use the graduated steps, identified below, as a strategy to guide children in these domains. Educators will use redirection, positive guidance strategies and encourage natural and logical consequences, where appropriate, to be a guiding instrument for developing positive interactions and self-regulatory behaviours. JHCCLC will not use 'time out' as a guidance strategy.

- Redirection**:** Children will be redirected to alternative activities as required.
- Resolve/Reason: When the child is calm and in a ready state for engagement, educators using age and developmentally appropriate language will explain how the behaviour or action impacts the child and others. Educators will acknowledge the child's feelings and needs, ensuring that the child's voice is dominant in the discourse. Educators will then assist the child to explore alternative strategies to manage situations promoting their sense of efficacy and the capacity to self-regulate.

Photos and Videos

The children will be photographed and videoed daily as part of our pedagogical documentation, making the children's learning visible. Parents will be asked to sign a consent form when photos will be requested for the purposes of posting in the Centre or for promotional purposes. If a family has any objection to their child's image being displayed or used for documentation in the Centre or for promotion, this can be indicated on the enrollment forms.

Volunteers and Placement Students Supervision

JHCCLC may have volunteers and/or college/university students doing work placement within the Centre. At all times, volunteers and placement students will be under the direction and supervision of Junior Hub educators. Only employees of Junior Hub will have direct, unsupervised access to children. We value supporting educators in training and see the impact they have not only on the children in care but also the educators in their professional growth. Volunteers are also a valuable asset to the Centre.

All students and volunteers must provide a current Police Vulnerable Sector Check, proof of immunizations, standard first aid and CPR and complete all required sign offs on Centre policies and procedures prior to interacting with the children.

Confidentiality

JHCCLC supports and adheres to the Code of Ethics and Standards of Practice developed by the College of Early Childhood Educators (CECE), Ontario. All educators are expected to adhere to the Code and use this Code to guide their daily behaviour in working with the children, families and the community as a whole. As educators, we are obligated to maintain the confidentiality of information obtained in the course of professional dealings with the children and families.

Educators Responsibility : Reporting to Children's Aid Society

In the event that a child makes a disclosure to an educators or a child's behaviour raises concern regarding abuse or neglect, educators are *legally required* to and *will always* contact the

Children's Aid Society.

Please understand that this is a very difficult process for the educators, parents and especially for the children. Educators will follow the direction of the Children's Aid Society through the reporting and response process. These matters are held in strict confidence, unless there is a duty to report. JHCCLC will support the family through this process.

Parent Concerns and Procedures

It is the intent that JHCCLC will continue to develop positive partnerships with each child and family and will promote a friendly atmosphere. All matters be discussed privately and a reasonable solution determined to bring about remedying the situation.

Parents are encouraged to take an active role in our child care centre and regularly discuss what their child is experiencing with our program. As supported by our Program Statement, we support positive and responsive interactions among the children, parents, child care providers and staff, and foster the engagement of and ongoing communication with parents about the program and their children. Issues/concerns may be brought forward verbally or in writing. Responses and outcomes will be provided verbally, or in writing upon request. The level of detail provided to the parent/guardian will respect and maintain the confidentiality of all parties involved. All issues and concerns raised by parents/ guardians are taken seriously by all the staff members at JHCCLC. Every effort will be made to address and resolve issues and concerns to the satisfaction of all parties and as quickly as possible. An initial response to an issue or concern will be provided to parents/guardians within 1-3 business day(s). The person who raised the issue/concern will be kept informed throughout the resolution process. The investigations of issues and concerns will be fair, impartial and respectful to parties involved.

Parking

Registration Package

- **What you Need to Know Before Your First Day**
- **Parent/Guardian Agreement**
- **Child Enrolment Information**
- **Child Health Information**
- **Immunization Record Cover Page**
- **Getting to Know Me**
- **Attendance Reporting Consent Form**
- **HiMama Information and Permission**

Appendix A- Fee Schedule